Yoorim Son

October 2026

Sogang University
M.A. Student in Economics
Seoul, Korea

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Education

Sogang University, Seoul, Korea — Mar 2025-present
M.A. in Economics; expected graduation: 2027
Advisor: Hyunjoo Yang

Hankuk University of Foreign Studies — Mar 2017-Feb 2021
B.A. in South African Languages and Cultures; Yongin, Korea
Minor in Political Science and Diplomacy

University of Botswana, Gaborone, Botswana — Jan-May 2018
Visiting / Exchange Student; coursework in Political Science

Research Fields

Development economics; applied microeconomics; digital infrastructure; local economic development and spatial inequality; geospatial and satellite-based economic measurement.

Working Papers

Mobile Broadband Upgrading and Spatial Inequality in South Africa (with Hyunjoo Yang). October 2026.

Uses quarterly Ookla measurements to compare mobile broadband upgrading across South African municipalities by initial service quality, baseline poverty, and regulatory priority during the 2021-2024 spectrum transition.

Tracks low-speed service, average performance, and high-speed expansion to distinguish local improvements from changes in gaps across places. Separate exploratory poverty comparisons include inference and measurement-coverage checks.

Research Experience

Sogang Spatial Economics & AI Lab — Apr 2026-present
Research Group Member (Master's Student), Sogang University
Lab Head: Hyunjoo Yang

Contribute to agricultural prediction using machine learning and spatial data within a lab working on geospatial data, economics, and Korea's development.

Collected and constructed maize and rice ground-truth datasets; completed the rice sampling workflow and am constructing XGBoost features to predict cultivated area across Asian countries.

MIRACLE: Subnational Economic Data for South Korea, 1960-1989 — Nov 2025-present
Research Associate; Project Leads: BooKang Seol, Changkeun Lee, and Hyunjoo Yang

Contribute to a consistent township-year economic panel using municipal statistical yearbooks and archival records, with geographic identifiers spanning administrative boundary changes.

Completed administrative-region data collection and coordinated a five-person collection team.

Currently work on OCR-based extraction and processing of historical statistical records.

Seminars & Conferences

2026 Korean Economic Review (KER) International Conference — June 22, 2026
Halla Convention Center, Jeju, South Korea

The Economic Impact of Submarine Cable Arrival on Local Economic Activity: Evidence from South Africa (with Hyunjoo Yang).
Presenter; Contributed Session A5: Empirical Microeconomics

Planned Collaboration

Satellite-Based Measurement of North Korean Economic Activity — Upcoming
Bank of Korea

Planned collaboration using satellite data to estimate industrial production and develop measures of economic activity where conventional statistics are limited.

Methods & Data

Programming: Python.
Empirical methods: Fixed effects, event studies, spatial exposure designs, synthetic-control diagnostics; training in difference-in-differences and instrumental variables.
Machine learning: XGBoost, sampling, and feature construction.
Data: Panel and administrative data, broadband performance, GIS and satellite-derived measures, historical archives, crop ground-truth data, and OCR workflows.

Languages

Korean: Native; English: Intermediate (academic reading and writing).